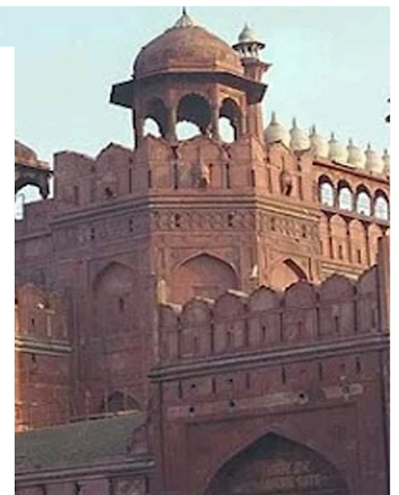
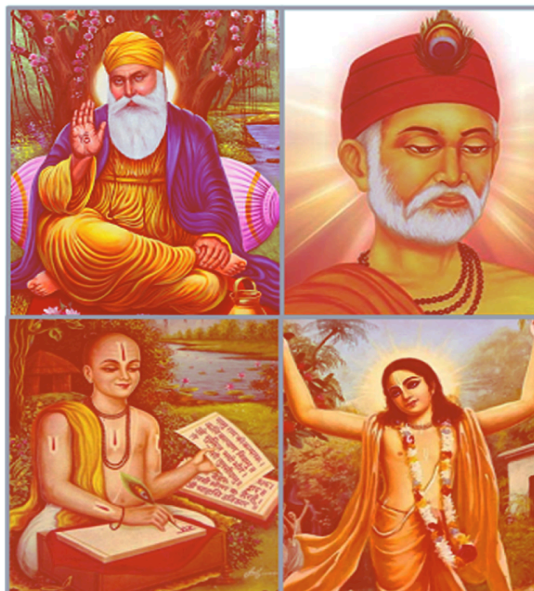
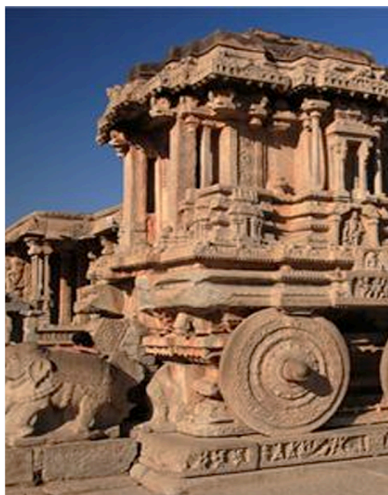


General Knowledge

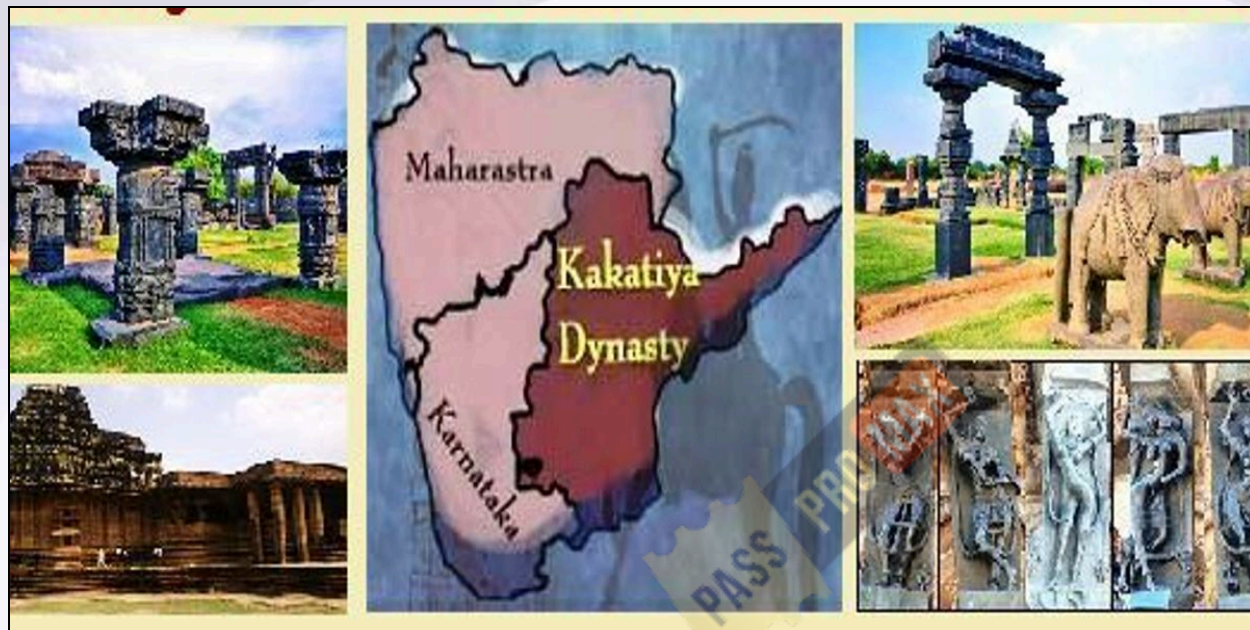
Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

Regional Kingdoms - Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Yadavas



Regional Kingdoms - Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Yadavas



Introduction

The **decline of major dynasties** such as the **Cholas, Chalukyas, and Pallavas** created a **power vacuum** in **South India**, leading to the rise of several **regional kingdoms**. From the **10th to the 14th centuries**, South India saw the emergence of powerful dynasties like the **Kakatiyas, Hoysalas, Yadavas, Pandya, and Chola Empires**, each contributing significantly to the **political, cultural, and economic landscape** of the region.

- These regional kingdoms **flourished independently** and laid the foundation for **local identities**, while also resisting invasions from the **north**.
- Their rule is marked by **great advancements in temple architecture, literature, and administrative reforms**.
- However, constant **conflicts among these kingdoms**, along with invasions from the **Delhi Sultanate**, eventually led to their decline.

Key Factors Leading to the Rise of Regional Kingdoms

- **The decline of Chalukyas and Cholas:** As the influence of the Cholas and Chalukyas declined, their feudatories such as the **Kakatiyas and Hoysalas** asserted their independence.
- **Local Leadership: Powerful local chieftains and military commanders** like **Sala of Hoysala** and **Prola Raja II of Kakatiya** established control over their respective regions.
- **Political Fragmentation:** With no central authority to maintain unity, **South India became a cluster of small kingdoms**, each expanding its territory.
- **Economic Prosperity:** Many regional rulers encouraged **agriculture, trade, and temple construction**, ensuring economic stability and regional dominance.
- **Resistance to Northern Invasions:** The kingdoms also sought to **defend their autonomy** from the invading **Delhi Sultanate** and maintained local governance structures.

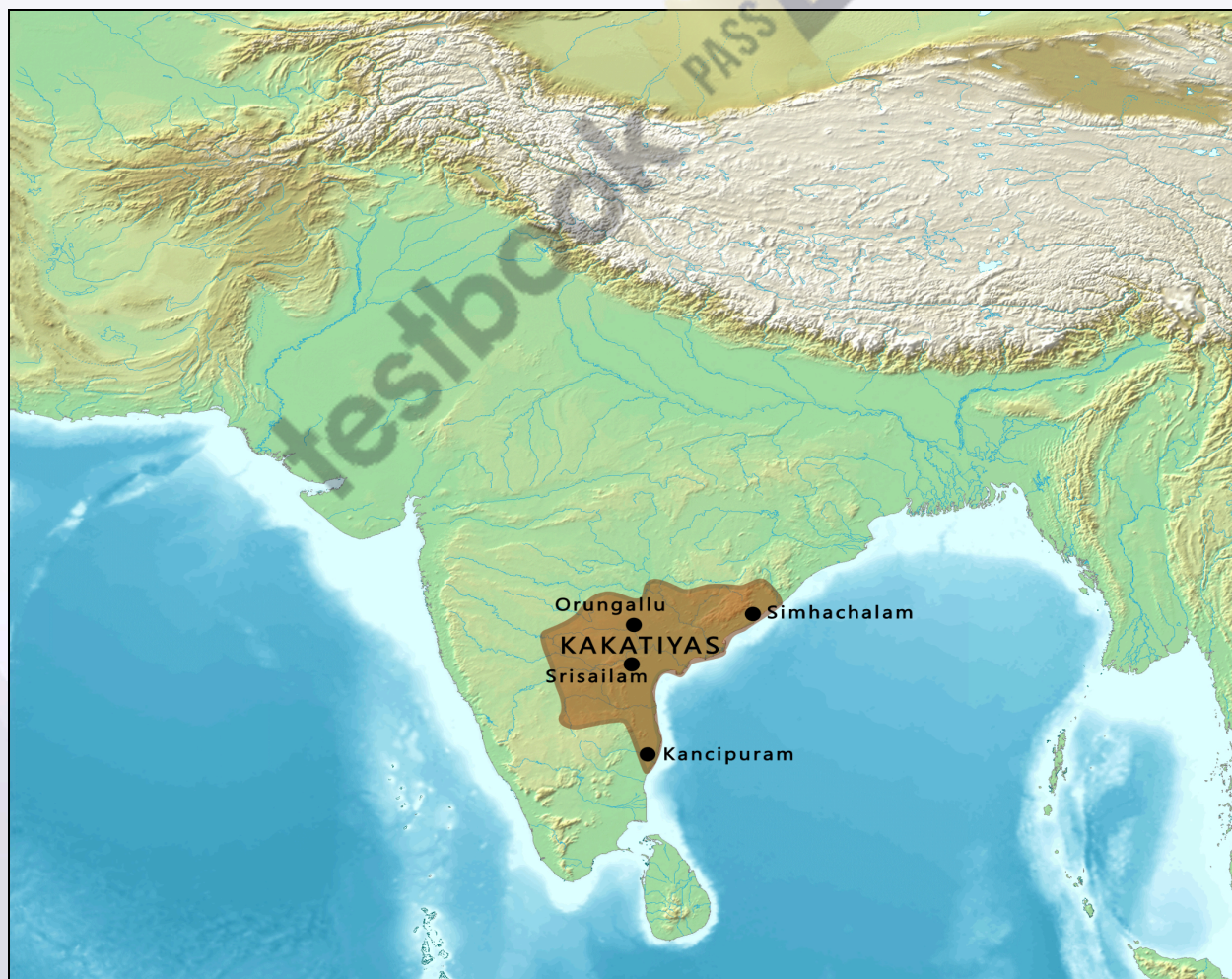
Comparison of Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Yadavas

Kingdom	Capital	Founder	Key Rulers	Notable Features
Kakatiyas	Warangal	Prola I	Rudrama Devi, Prataparudra II	Famous for irrigation systems and Warangal Fort . Promoted Telugu literature . Fell to the Delhi Sultanate in 1323 CE.
Hoysalas	Halebidu	Nripa Kama I	Vishnuvardhana, Veera Ballala II, Veera Ballala III	Known for Chennakesava Temple and Hoysaleswara Temple . Promoted Kannada literature . Their traditions influenced the Vijayanagara Empire .
Yadavas	Devagiri	Dridhaprahar	Simhana, Ramachandra	Promoted Marathi literature and Hemadpanti

				architecture. Fell to Alauddin Khilji's invasion.
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Kakatiya Dynasty (1163 – 1323 AD)

- The **Kakatiya Dynasty** was a **medieval South Indian dynasty** that ruled over the **Telugu-speaking regions** of present-day **Andhra Pradesh and Telangana**.
- Their reign from the **12th to 14th centuries** played a pivotal role in shaping the **socio-political landscape** of South India.
- The Kakatiyas started as **feudatories of the Western Chalukyas** and gradually established their independence.
- Their governance was marked by **architectural innovations, irrigation systems, and literary contributions**.



Origin and Establishment

- **Founder: Prola Raja II**, a Chalukya vassal, is considered the **founder** of the Kakatiya Dynasty.
- **Rise to Power:**
 - In **1163 AD**, **Prataparudra I** declared independence from the Chalukyas and established the Kakatiya dynasty as a **sovereign power**.
 - The Kakatiyas extended their territory across **Telangana, Andhra Pradesh**, parts of **eastern Karnataka**, and **southern Odisha**.
- **Capital Cities:**
 - **Hanumakonda** was the first capital.
 - **Orugallu (Warangal)** became the permanent capital during the reign of **Ganapati Deva**.

Territorial Expansion and Administration

- The Kakatiya kings expanded their domain through **conquest** and **alliances**, becoming a dominant force in the **Deccan plateau**.
- They **organized the territory into administrative units** with a focus on local governance, promoting **agriculture and trade**.
- **Feudal lords were integrated into governance**, and temple-building projects were encouraged, promoting stability and prosperity.

Notable Rulers of the Kakatiya Dynasty

Ruler	Reign	Key Contributions	Key Events
Prataparudra I	1158 – 1195 AD	• Declared the end of allegiance to the Chalukyas. • Authored 'Nitisara', a text on statecraft in Sanskrit.	• Palanadu War took place, consolidating Kakatiya control over the Telugu regions.

Ganapati Deva	1198 - 1262 AD	- Shifted the capital from Hanumakonda to Warangal, strengthening administration. Created Pakhal Lake to support agriculture. - Issued the 'Abhaya Sasanam' to encourage trade at Motupalli port. - Patronized Tikkana Somayaji, a renowned poet.	Warangal emerged as a major center of trade and administration.
Rudrama Devi	1262 - 1296 AD	First female ruler of the dynasty, ruled with strength and vision. - Adopted a male title to command respect and authority. Defended the kingdom from rebellions and external threats.	Italian traveler Marco Polo visited her court and praised her governance.
Prataparudra II	1296 - 1323 AD	Resisted invasions from the Delhi Sultanate under Alauddin Khilji and Gayasuddin Tughlaq.	- Warangal fell to the Tughlaqs in 1323 AD. - Prataparudra II was captured, marking the end of Kakatiya rule.

Literary Contributions

- The Kakatiya period saw **significant advancements in literature**, with many **poets and scholars** flourishing under their patronage.
- Jayapa Senani**: Wrote **Geeta Ratnavali**, **Nritya Ratnavali**, and **Vadya Ratnavali**, contributing to dance and music traditions.
- Tikkana Somayaji**: Authored works such as **Nirvachanottara Ramayanamu** and **Krishnasatakamu**.
- Court scholars** promoted **Telugu and Sanskrit literature**, enriching the region's cultural heritage.

Religious and Cultural Influence

- Although the Kakatiyas primarily followed **Hinduism**, they showed **tolerance towards Jainism** and other faiths.
- They were instrumental in **promoting temple worship**, and commissioning numerous temples dedicated to **Shiva, Vishnu, and Surya**.
- The dynasty's focus on **art, literature, and architecture** laid the foundation for the cultural development of the Telugu region.

Decline and Fall of the Kakatiya Dynasty

- The **Delhi Sultanate under Alauddin Khilji** launched a series of **invasions** into the Deccan region during the late 13th and early 14th centuries.
- **Prataparudra II** fought against the Khilji forces but was eventually defeated.
- **Gayasuddin Tughlaq** invaded Warangal in **1323 AD**, capturing the city and **ending the Kakatiya dynasty**.
- After the Kakatiya fall, the region became vulnerable to **external invasions**, paving the way for the rise of the **Bahmani Sultanate**.

Legacy of the Kakatiya Dynasty

- **Architectural Style:** The **Kakatiya architecture**, with its focus on **temple building and irrigation systems**, influenced later dynasties in the region.
- **Tank Irrigation:** The **extensive tank systems** developed by the Kakatiyas continued to benefit the region for centuries.
- **Cultural Identity:** The dynasty's promotion of **Telugu literature** laid the foundation for **Telugu cultural identity**.
- **Influence on the Successor States:** The **Vijayanagara Empire** and the **Bahmani Sultanate** inherited many of the administrative practices and cultural traditions of the Kakatiyas.

Hoysala Dynasty (1050 – 1355 AD)

- The **Hoysala Dynasty** was a **prominent South Indian kingdom** that ruled over the **Karnataka region** and parts of **Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu**.

- Their rise began as **feudatories of the Western Chalukyas**, but they emerged as **independent rulers** by the 11th century.
- The Hoysala period marked a **golden age in art, architecture, literature, and administration**, leaving a lasting impact on the history of South India.



Origin and Establishment

- **Founder: Sala**, a local chieftain, is traditionally considered the **founder** of the Hoysala dynasty.
- **Legend of Origin:** According to legend, **Sala killed a tiger** at the command of his Jain guru, symbolizing the establishment of the dynasty.
- **Feudatory Roots:** The Hoysalas started as **vassals of the Western Chalukyas**, gradually gaining autonomy.

Rise to Power

- **Vishnuvardhana (1108 – 1152 AD)** is credited with **establishing the Hoysala kingdom's independence**.

- By **defeating the Cholas in 1116 AD**, Vishnuvardhana expanded Hoysala's control over **Gangavadi** and other regions.
- **Halebidu (Dorasamudra)** and **Belur** became the capitals of the Hoysala Empire.
- Their rise coincided with **political instability in South India**, which allowed them to **expand their territory** across **modern-day Karnataka** and parts of Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh.

Territorial Expansion and Administration

- The Hoysalas **divided their kingdom into administrative units** such as **Nadu, Vishaya, Kampana**, and **Desha** for efficient governance.
- Their administration focused on **local autonomy**, with **feudal lords and merchants** playing key roles.
- The dynasty **flourished economically**, with agricultural prosperity and trade contributing to the stability of the kingdom.

Notable Rulers of the Hoysala Dynasty

Ruler	Reign	Key Contributions	Key Events
Vishnuvardhana	1108 - 1152 AD	• Titles: Bitti Deva, Talakadugonda (Conqueror of Talakad). • Religion: Initially a Jain, but converted to Vaishnavism under Ramanujacharya's influence. • Military Achievements: - Defeated the Cholas and captured Gangavadi (southern Karnataka). - Expanded territory to include parts of Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu. • Architectural Contributions: - Built the Vijayanarayana Temple (Chennakesava Temple)	• Victory over the Cholas marked the expansion of Hoysala influence. • Belur became an important center of architecture.

		at Belur to commemorate victory over the Cholas. - Patronized the Keerthi Narayana Temple at Talakad.	
Veera Ballala II	1173 - 1220 AD	• One of the most powerful rulers of the Hoysala dynasty. • Military Conquests: - Fought against Yadavas of Devagiri, Kalachuris, and Pandyas of Madurai. - Defended the kingdom from Delhi Sultanate incursions. • Patron of Literature and Art: - Supported Jain poets like Janna and Nemichandra. - Patronized Rudrabhatta, a Brahman poet.	• Strengthened the Hoysala kingdom through military conquests and literary patronage. • Ensured the stability of the empire amidst external threats.
Veera Ballala III	1292 - 1343 AD	• Reunified the Hoysala kingdom after a period of decline. • His reign involved continuous warfare with the Sultanate of Madurai and Delhi Sultanate. • Decline: - He was killed in the Battle of Madurai (1343 AD). - After his death, Hoysala territories merged with the Vijayanagara Empire.	• Marked the end of the Hoysala dynasty. • Vijayanagara Empire absorbed the Hoysala legacy.

Contributions to Architecture and Art

The Hoysala dynasty is renowned for developing a distinct architectural style, often referred to as the **Hoysala School of Architecture**. Their temples are known for **intricate carvings**, **elaborate pillars**, and **unique floor plans**.

Key Features of Hoysala Architecture

- **Multiple Shrines:** Temples often had multiple shrines arranged around a **central pillared hall** (mandapa).
- **Material Used: Soft soapstone** (chlorite schist) was used for intricate carvings.
- **Stellate Plan:** Many temples were constructed in a **zig-zag star-like pattern** (stellate plan).
- **Jagati:** Temples were built on an elevated platform called **Jagati**, about 1 meter high.
- **Intricately Carved Walls:** The walls were adorned with **detailed sculptures** depicting scenes from **Hindu epics** like the **Ramayana** and **Mahabharata**.

Famous Temples Built by the Hoysalas

Temple	Location	Built By	Dedicated To	Key Features
Chennakesava Temple	Belur, Karnataka	Vishnuvardhana	Commemorate s his victory over the Cholas	• Known for lathe-turned pillars and intricate carvings. • Depicts stories from Shaivism, Vaishnavism, and Jainism.
Hoysaleswara Temple	Halebidu, Karnataka	Vishnuvardhana	Lord Shiva	• A twin temple with extensive sculptures and carvings. • Features legends from the Ramayana, Mahabharata, and Puranas.

Kesava Temple	Somanatha pura, Karnataka	Narasimha III (1268 AD)	Lord Vishnu	• Known for symmetrical architecture and lathe-turned pillars. • Depicts scenes from the Bhagavata Purana and the Ramayana.
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Literary Contributions

- The Hoysala period saw significant growth in **Kannada and Sanskrit literature**.
- **Janna**: Wrote **Yashodharacharite**, a story about a prince's sacrifice.
- **Harihara**: Authored **Girijakalyana**, narrating the **marriage of Shiva and Parvati**.
- **Rudrabhatta**: Composed **Jagannatha Vijaya**, describing **Krishna's battle with Banasura**.
- **Vidyatirtha** and **Madhvacharya**: Prominent scholars who contributed to religious and philosophical literature.

Religious Influence

- The Hoysalas initially followed **Jainism**, but many rulers, such as **Vishnuvardhana**, later converted to **Vaishnavism** under the influence of **Ramanujacharya**.
- **Shaivism, Vaishnavism, and Jainism** coexisted during their reign, with temples dedicated to **Shiva, Vishnu**, and Jain Tirthankaras.

Decline of the Hoysala Dynasty

- The **continuous invasions** from the **Delhi Sultanate** weakened the Hoysala kingdom.
- **Veera Ballala III** tried to defend the kingdom but was defeated in the **Battle of Madurai (1343 AD)**.
- After his death, the remaining Hoysala territories merged into the **Vijayanagara Empire**, marking the **end of the Hoysala reign**.

Legacy of the Hoysala Dynasty

- The **Hoysala architectural style** influenced later dynasties, including the **Vijayanagara Empire**.
- Their temples, especially the **Chennakesava and Hoysaleswara Temples**, remain major **tourist attractions and architectural marvels** today.
- The **growth of Kannada literature** under their patronage contributed to the **cultural identity** of Karnataka.
- The **irrigation systems** and local governance practices implemented by the Hoysalas influenced the region for centuries.

Yadava Dynasty (1187 – 1317 AD)

- The **Yadava Dynasty**, also known as the **Seuna Dynasty**, ruled over the **Deccan Plateau** from **Devagiri (modern-day Daulatabad, Maharashtra)**.
- Initially, the Yadavas were **feudatories of the Western Chalukyas**, but they declared their independence as the Chalukyan power declined.
- Their reign was marked by **economic prosperity, military conquests, architectural innovations**, and the **promotion of Marathi literature**.
- However, the dynasty eventually fell to the **Delhi Sultanate** during the early 14th century.

Origin and Establishment

- **Founder: Bhillama V** is considered the **founder** of the Yadava Dynasty.
- **Capital: Devagiri (Daulatabad)** was established as the capital after Bhillama V expanded his territories.
- **Extent of Rule:**
 - The Yadava kingdom controlled areas of **Maharashtra, North Karnataka**, and parts of **Madhya Pradesh**.
 - Their strategic location on the **Deccan plateau** allowed them to control key **trade routes**.

Rise to Power

- The Yadavas **rose to prominence** during the decline of the **Western Chalukyas** in the 12th century.

- **Bhillama V** took advantage of the Chalukyan weakening and **declared independence in 1187 AD.**
- The dynasty expanded its influence by waging **wars against neighbouring kingdoms**, including the **Hoysalas, Paramaras, and Kakatiyas.**



Administration and Economy

- The Yadavas **encouraged trade and agriculture**, resulting in a **stable economy.**
- **Land grants** were given to Brahmins and scholars, which promoted **education and culture.**
- The Yadavas were among the first dynasties to **adopt Marathi** as their **official language**, fostering regional identity.

Notable Rulers of the Yadava Dynasty

Ruler	Reign	Achievements / Military Conquests	Patronage and Legacy
Bhillama V	1173 - 1191 AD	- Declared independence from the Chalukyas and established Devagiri as the capital. - Fought against the Hoysala king Ballala II and captured the Chalukyan capital of Kalyani.	Supported scholars, including Bhaskara II, a renowned mathematician.
Simhana II	1200 - 1246 AD	- Launched military campaigns against the Hoysalas and Paramaras to expand his territories. - Defeated Bhoja II of the Kolhapur Shilaharas, consolidating Yadava control over Maharashtra.	- Patronized Sarangadeva, the author of Sangeet Ratnakara (a key text on Indian music). - Scholars like Anantadeva and Cangadeva flourished during his reign.
Ramchandra	1291 - 1309 AD	- Fought wars against the Vaghelas, Kakatiyas, Hoysalas, and Paramaras. - In 1308 AD, Malik Kafur, under Alauddin Khalji, defeated and captured him.	After his release, Ramchandra had to pay tribute to the Delhi Sultanate, marking the beginning of the Yadava kingdom's decline.

Architectural Contributions

- The Yadavas developed the **Hemadpanti style of architecture**, characterized by the use of **locally available black stone** without mortar.
- Gondeshwar Temple, Sinnar:**

- This temple, built in the **Bhumija style**, is dedicated to **Lord Shiva** and features a **Panchayatana layout** (a main shrine surrounded by four smaller shrines).
- Several **forts and temples** across Maharashtra reflect the **architectural innovations** of the Yadava period.

Literary Contributions

- The Yadava dynasty was the **first to use Marathi as an official language**, promoting **regional literature and identity**.
- **Important Literary Works:**
 - **Mukundaraya: Vivekasindhu**, a philosophical text.
 - **Hemadri: Chaturanga Chintamani** (on astrology) and other works in Sanskrit.
 - **Dnyaneshwar: Dnyaneshwari**, a **Marathi commentary on the Bhagavad Gita**, remains a foundational text of Marathi literature.
 - **Sarangapani: Sangeet Ratnakara**, an influential work on **music theory**.
 - **Mahimabhatta: Lilacharita**, a religious narrative in Marathi.

Religion and Cultural Influence

- The Yadavas were followers of **Shaivism** but showed **tolerance toward Vaishnavism and Jainism**.
- Temples dedicated to **Shiva and Vishnu** were built across their territories.
- Their patronage of **Marathi language and culture** played a significant role in the development of **regional identity** in Maharashtra.

Decline of the Yadava Dynasty

- **Malik Kafur's invasion of Devagiri in 1308 AD** severely weakened the Yadavas.
- **Ramchandra** was captured but released on the condition that he pay **regular tribute** to the Delhi Sultanate.
- In **1317 AD**, the Delhi Sultanate fully annexed the Yadava kingdom by **killing the last ruler, Simhana III**.
- The fall of the Yadavas marked the beginning of **Muslim dominance** in the Deccan, paving the way for the rise of the **Bahmani Sultanate**.

Legacy of the Yadava Dynasty

- The **Yadavas' patronage of Marathi literature** laid the foundation for the **Marathi language and culture**.
- Their **Hemadpanti style of architecture** influenced later temple construction across Maharashtra.
- The **Gondeshwar Temple at Sinnar** remains a symbol of their architectural excellence.
- The dynasty's administrative practices and promotion of **local languages and culture** contributed to the development of **regional identities** in the Deccan.

